

Windows XP. Want to experience the Windows ecosystem on your Intel-powered iMac or MacBook? Easy peasy, just go to Mac OS X's built-in Boot Camp utility and you can dual-boot your Mac with Windows. Bored with either of the two? Linux, championing the cause of open-source, is always available – for free – and with an assortment of flavours.

Despite Microsoft Windows' monopoly on Intel and AMD based x86 and x64 machines, it was still quite easy to pop in a CD or DVD into your laptop's optical drive tray and wipe out one operating system for another. Windows for another flavour of Windows, Mac OS X for Windows, Windows for Linux, and so on. It wasn't exactly child's play, but it wasn't exactly rocket science either. The idea of switching between OSes and platforms was acceptable, even if it wasn't endorsed by device manufac-



turers. That was back then. It's a different world we inhabit now, a world where manufacturers of smart handheld devices and the platforms they endorse frown upon switching OSes on any of their handheld devices up for purchase – forget switching, even minor alterations or tweaks to a device's software void its warranty. This means that the non-tech savvy, basic consumer (which forms majority of the consumer base) is stuck on a platform when they buy a mobile device – be it a tablet or smartphone. Unhappy with your platform? Want a different OS? Buy a new device. Sorry. Take it or leave it.

Welcome to the Post-PC era where Google, Apple, Microsoft, Blackberry and also Nokia, Samsung, Mozilla, Canonical and a few others possessing an enterprising brain are busy constructing walled gardens, competing with each other. Walled gardens (re: platforms) that are being erected on every device to keep users engaged and entertained within that environment, where they shouldn't feel or have the choice to migrate to another readily available platform easily. However, with so many companies